

Game QA Case Study

Mobile Farm Game · First Player Session

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GOAL

Evaluate the first player session and identify issues that may affect onboarding, gameplay clarity, UI feedback, and the overall player experience.

SCOPE

First Launch · Tutorial · Planting / Harvesting Loop · Resource Counters · Rewards · Blocked Actions · UI Feedback · Basic Performance

WHAT I CHECKED

- Whether the tutorial is clear for a new player
- Whether controls are understandable
- Whether rewards and resources update correctly
- Whether the player receives feedback for unavailable actions
- Whether animations or popups overlap important UI elements

MAIN FINDINGS

1. Tutorial — Premature Action Access

Some actions can be tapped before the tutorial has explained them. This may cause confusion or allow the player to skip intended learning steps, breaking the designed onboarding flow.

Recommendation: Restrict interactive elements until the tutorial step that introduces them has been completed.

2. Resource Updates — Weak Visual Feedback

When resources change (e.g. coins, crops), the counter updates without sufficient visual reinforcement. A new player may not notice the change or understand what triggered it.

Recommendation: Add a brief animation — number pop, colour flash, or floating delta value (+12 ?) — directly on the resource counter at the moment of change.

3. Blocked Actions — No Explanation

When an action is unavailable, it is either greyed out or simply unresponsive, with no tooltip or message explaining why. Players are left to guess whether it is a bug or an intentional restriction.

Recommendation: Display a short inline hint on tap: e.g. "Not enough coins" or "Unlock at Level 3".

4. Confusing UI States for New Players

Certain UI states — such as partially loaded screens, overlapping popups, or animations playing over action buttons — may disorient a first-time player and make the interface feel unstable.

Recommendation: Audit popup z-order and animation timing to ensure critical UI elements (buttons, counters) remain visible and accessible at all times.

RESULT

Prepared bug reports and improvement recommendations covering:

- Onboarding clarity — tutorial gating, step sequencing
- Gameplay feedback — resource counter animations, harvest confirmations
- First-session experience — blocked-action hints, UI state consistency

Each finding was documented with steps to reproduce, expected vs actual behaviour, severity level, and a suggested fix.

TOOLS USED

[DevTools](#) · [Charles](#) · [Jira / Tracker](#) · [Figma](#) · [Miro](#) · [Sentry](#) · [TestFlight / Debug Build](#)